



THE HIDDEN HORIZON

Official Treasure Hunt Planning Document

Event The Hidden Horizon	Organized By Rakshitha & Radhika
Format Multi-Round Team Treasure Hunt	Volunteers 12+ Volunteers Assigned

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01 — Event Overview

□ The Hidden Horizon is a multi-phase, campus-wide treasure hunt designed for teams. The game combines riddle-solving, puzzle-cracking, location-based challenges, and a final cipher to determine the winner. The experience is immersive, competitive, and driven by teamwork.

Phase 1 Elimination Round	Emoji film guesses + Number puzzles (if 10+ teams)
Phase 2 Classroom Briefing	Team names assigned, rules explained by heads
Phase 3 Treasure Hunt	Multi-stop campus hunt: Library → Canteen → Gym → Lab → Outdoor
Phase 4 Final Challenge	Cipher code solving → Final gift for winners

02 — Phase 1: Elimination Round

The Elimination Round determines which teams advance to the main treasure hunt. Whether it is held depends on the number of participating teams.

Teams Registered	Elimination Round?	Teams Advancing
Less than 9 teams	✗ Not Held	All teams proceed directly
Exactly 10 teams	✓ Yes	Top 6 teams advance
More than 10 teams	✓ Yes	Top 8 teams advance

03 — Elimination Round: Question Structure

Each team receives a single question paper containing 20 questions split across two categories:

Category 1 Emoji Film Guesses	Category 2 Number Puzzles
- A set of emojis represents a movie title - Teams must identify the correct film name - Tests pop culture and lateral thinking	- Numerical logic and pattern-based puzzles - Requires quick calculation and reasoning - Tests analytical speed under pressure

04 — Team Selection Criteria

Teams are ranked and selected based on two factors, evaluated in order:

#	Criteria	Details
1	Timing	Teams that complete the paper fastest are ranked higher
2	✓ Correctness	In case of a tie in timing, the team with more correct answers wins

05 — Phase 2: Classroom Briefing

Once qualifying teams are selected, all teams are brought into the classroom for the official game briefing. This session is conducted by the Heads of the Treasure Hunt — Rakshitha and Radhika.

What Happens in the Briefing:

1. Each team is officially assigned a unique Team Name (e.g., Dragon, Phoenix, Titan).
2. Each team is given their first riddle — a Location Riddle — which, when solved, will reveal their first stop on the hunt.
3. Full game rules, conduct guidelines, and instructions are explained to all teams.
4. Each team is introduced to their assigned volunteer, who will accompany them throughout the game.
5. The game officially begins once all teams leave the classroom with their riddle.

06 — Volunteer Assignment

A total of 12+ volunteers are involved in running The Hidden Horizon. They are split into two categories:

Team-Assigned Volunteers	Location-Sitting Volunteers
- One volunteer assigned per team - Follows the team throughout the game - Assists with QR scanning and navigation - Does NOT give game hints or answers	- Stationed at each designated location - Verifies team name before giving clue paper - Manages location-specific challenges or games - Stays at their post for the duration of the game

07 — Phase 3: The Treasure Hunt — Location Flow

Once the classroom briefing concludes, teams solve their location riddle to determine their first stop. Each stop follows a consistent structure: arrive → verify team name → receive clue/task → solve → scan QR → move to next stop.

Stop	Location	Key Activity
1	Library	Solve rack riddle → Find code in book → Scan QR
2	Canteen	Search for 'Dragon' paper under chairs → Optional puzzle → Complete code → Scan QR
3	Gym	Complete a simple in-location game/challenge → Scan QR
4	Computer Lab	Find the laptop with 'Dragon' wallpaper using clue (e.g., Row 3, Near Window) → Get code → Scan QR
5	Outdoor Location	Chosen by chit: Ground / B-Block / Hostel / Parking → Navigate map → Collect 5 Fossils → Advance to Final

Stop 1 — Library

How It Works:

1. The team arrives at the Library and the sitting volunteer asks for their Team Name.
2. Based on the team name, the volunteer hands over a specific paper. This paper contains a riddle that points to a rack and book — written in riddle form, not directly.
3. Inside the identified book, a code number is hidden (e.g., DRAGON124).
4. The team uses this code to locate the corresponding QR code.
5. The team's volunteer assists with scanning the QR code. The scan reveals the next location.

Example:

Team receives paper → Riddle points to Rack 3, Shelf B → Book found → Code: DRAGON124 → QR scanned → Next stop: Canteen

Stop 2 — Canteen

How It Works:

1. The team arrives at the Canteen. The sitting volunteer greets them and asks for their Team Name.
2. The volunteer instructs them to 'Search Dragon' — meaning they must find a physical paper with a Dragon picture hidden somewhere in the canteen (e.g., stuck under a chair, under a table, or on a surface).
3. Under the Dragon paper, a code is written. However, the code may be incomplete — some characters are missing.
4. To recover the missing characters, the team must complete an optional puzzle challenge offered by the canteen volunteer. Each puzzle solved reveals one missing character of the code.
5. Once the full code is assembled, the team scans the QR code and proceeds to the next location.

□ Note on Optional Puzzle:

The puzzle is optional in the sense that the team chooses how many puzzles to attempt. However, each missing character can only be obtained by solving the corresponding puzzle — so skipping puzzles means an incomplete code.

Stop 3 — □ Gym

How It Works:

1. The team arrives at the Gym where the location volunteer is stationed.
2. A simple in-location game or physical/mental challenge is presented to the team.
3. Upon completing the challenge, the team receives the QR code for the next stop.
4. The volunteer assists with scanning. The QR reveals the Computer Lab as the next destination.

□ Suggested Challenge Types:

- Quick trivia round (3 questions)
- A simple physical challenge (e.g., relay, balance task)
- Team coordination mini-game

Stop 4 — Computer Lab

How It Works:

- The team enters the Computer Lab where the location volunteer is stationed.
- One specific laptop in the lab has been set with a Dragon wallpaper — this is the target machine.
- The team does not know which laptop it is. Instead, they are given a positional clue — for example: "I am in Row 3, near the Window."
- The team physically locates the matching laptop based on the clue and identifies it by the Dragon wallpaper.
- On or near that laptop, the next code is found. The team scans the corresponding QR to reveal the Outdoor Stop.

Example Clue:

"I sit in Row 3, close to the window, watching the world outside..." → Team finds the laptop with Dragon wallpaper in Row 3, Window side → Code obtained → QR scanned → Next: Outdoor Location

Stop 5 — Outdoor Location (Chosen by Chit)

The outdoor location adds a unique layer to the game: randomness and navigation. Unlike indoor stops, this location is chosen by the team themselves — but by chance, not choice.

Available Outdoor Locations	Selection Method
• Ground • B-Block Surroundings • Hostel Surroundings • Parking Area	Each team picks one chit from a set of four. The chit they draw determines their outdoor location. Each team may only select one outdoor spot.

The Map Challenge:

Upon arriving at their outdoor location, the team receives a custom map of that area. The map is designed to be challenging and deceptive:

- The map contains multiple routes — some are correct paths, others are dummy routes leading nowhere.
- The map includes locations marked as Danger Zones and Fossil Sites — but NO labels or hints distinguish one from the other on the map itself.
- Teams receive zero prior hints about which spots are dangerous and which contain fossils.
- The team must explore the map, navigate the routes, and physically collect 5 Fossils hidden in the area.

- Only after collecting all 5 Fossils does the team receive the final location clue, advancing them to the last phase.

□ **Important Design Note:**

The map is intentionally neutral in appearance. Danger Zones, Fossil Sites, and Dead-End Routes are all presented without distinguishing labels. The team must rely entirely on instinct, teamwork, and exploration to succeed.

08 — Phase 4: Final Cipher Challenge & Winners

The Final Phase is the culmination of the entire treasure hunt. After successfully collecting all 5 Fossils at the outdoor location, teams advance to the final destination where the ultimate challenge awaits.

□ The Cipher Challenge:

- At the final location, teams are presented with a Cipher Code — an encoded message that must be deciphered.
- The team must solve the cipher using all skills and knowledge accumulated throughout the hunt.
- The team that successfully decodes the cipher first wins the treasure hunt.
- The winning team receives the Final Gift — the ultimate reward of The Hidden Horizon.

□ WINNER TAKES ALL

The first team to crack the cipher and reach the treasure wins the Final Gift of The Hidden Horizon.

09 — Quick Reference Summary

#	Phase	Location / Stage	Activity / Objective
1	Elimination	Classroom / Open Area	20 Qs: Emoji film guesses + Number puzzles. Top 6 (if 10 teams) or top 8 (if 10+ teams) advance.
2	Briefing	Classroom	Team names assigned, Location Riddle given, volunteer assigned, rules explained.
3a	Hunt — Stop 1	Library	Solve rack riddle → Find code in book → Scan QR.
3b	Hunt — Stop 2	Canteen	Find Dragon paper → Incomplete code → Solve puzzle → Complete code → Scan QR.
3c	Hunt — Stop 3	Gym	Complete simple game/challenge → Scan QR.
3d	Hunt — Stop 4	Computer Lab	Find Dragon wallpaper laptop via positional clue → Get code → Scan QR.
3e	Hunt — Stop 5	Outdoor (Chit)	Navigate map → Avoid danger zones → Collect 5 Fossils → Advance to Final.
4	Final	Final Location	Solve Cipher Code → First team to crack it wins the Final Gift.

THE HIDDEN HORIZON | *May the best team find the treasure.*

10 — Names of each Rounds

Solve the final cipher to win.

Final — Cipher Dominion

Navigate map, collect fossils, and advance.

Level 5 — Terra Quest (Outdoor Location)

Locate the correct system using clues and retrieve code.

Level 4 — Data Core X (Computer Lab)

Complete a challenge to proceed.

Level 3 — Power Trials (Gym)

Search for hidden clue and solve puzzles to complete a code.

Level 2 — Ember Table (Canteen)

Decode a riddle to find a hidden book and code.

Level 1 — Mindlock Archives (Library)

The elimination round where teams solve emoji-based movie clues and number puzzles.

Phase 1 — Raptocode Break

11 — Rules, Regulations, Budget & Resources

SECTION 1 — RULES & REGULATIONS

A. General Event Rules

- All teams must register before the event.
- Fixed team members; no changes allowed.
- All members must attend briefing.
- Respectful behavior is mandatory.
- No cheating, clue sharing, or tampering.
- Organizer decisions are final.
- Phones only for QR scanning.

B. Round-Wise Rules

Elimination Round:

- Conducted if 10+ teams.
- 20 questions (emoji + number puzzles).
- Ranked by time and correctness.

Treasure Hunt Rules:

- Verify team name at each stop.
- No using other team clues.
- Tasks must be completed before moving.
- Follow all location-specific rules.

Final Round:

- Only teams with all fossils can participate.
- First correct cipher wins.

SECTION 2 — BUDGET OVERVIEW

Estimated Budget: Rs. 3000 (approx.)

Includes printing, materials, setup, volunteers, and prizes.

SECTION 3 — REQUIRED RESOURCES

Human Resources:

- 12+ volunteers including team guides and location heads.

Materials:

- QR codes, clue papers, maps, fossils, puzzle cards.

Technical:

- QR system, smartphones, one configured laptop.

Venues:

- Classroom, Library, Canteen, Gym, Lab, Outdoor locations.